

Push 2 / Nuendo Bridge

Windows Installation Guide — Version 1.0.4

Standalone .exe — no Python, no pip, no command line

From version 1.0.4 the Windows bridge is a single self-contained executable. The Python interpreter, every dependency and the libusb USB runtime are bundled inside the .exe. You only need to set up the virtual MIDI ports (loopMIDI), the Push 2 USB driver (Zadig) and the Nuendo/Cubase MIDI Remote script.

What you downloaded

- **Push2NuendoBridge-vX.Y.Z-Windows.zip** — unzip it anywhere you like (e.g. Documents\Push2Bridge). It contains:
- Push2 Nuendo Bridge_vX.Y.Z.exe — the bridge (double-click to run).
- Ableton_Push2.js — the Nuendo / Cubase MIDI Remote script.
- PDF guides (User Guide, Release Notes, Plugin Mapper Guide).

Do not delete the .exe after “installing” — it is the application; run it from wherever you keep the unzipped folder.

Step 1 — loopMIDI virtual ports

- Download and install loopMIDI: <https://www.tobias-erichsen.de/software/loopmidi.html>
- Open loopMIDI and create **four** ports with these EXACT names (type the name, click the + button):

```
NuendoBridge In  
NuendoBridge Out  
BridgeNotes  
BridgeNotes In
```

- Right-click the loopMIDI tray icon and enable “**Autostart loopMIDI**” so the ports exist every time Windows starts.

Step 2 — Push 2 USB driver (Zadig)

- The bridge talks to the Push 2 over raw USB and needs the **WinUSB** driver. This is a one-time setup.
- Close Ableton Live if it is running (it grabs the Push 2 exclusively).
- Download Zadig: <https://zadig.akeo.ie>
- Connect the Push 2 by USB. In Zadig: **Options** → **List All Devices**. Several entries named **Ableton Push 2** will appear in the dropdown — one per USB interface (the Push 2 is a composite device with MIDI and display interfaces).
- Select the **display/bulk interface** — **NOT** the MIDI interface. Identify it by the **USB ID 2982:1967** shown in Zadig (and typically labelled *Interface 0*). Picking the MIDI interface by mistake would replace its standard Windows MIDI driver and break MIDI input/output.

- With that interface selected, choose **WinUSB** as the target driver and click **Install Driver** (or **Replace Driver**). Wait for “The driver was installed successfully”.

Note: the bridge and Ableton Live share the same Push 2 USB endpoint, so they cannot both control the Push at the same time — close one to use the other. Recent Live versions (12.x tested) work fine with this same WinUSB driver, so in normal use no driver swap is required. If you ever need to fully restore Ableton’s original driver (older Live setups, or returning to a Live-only workflow), see “Restoring the original driver” below.

Restoring the original driver (optional, for older Live setups)

- Quit the bridge and close Ableton Live.
- Open **Device Manager** (right-click Start → Device Manager).
- Find **Ableton Push 2** — it appears under *Universal Serial Bus devices* (the WinUSB entry). Tip: View → *Devices by container* if you do not see it.
- Right-click it → **Uninstall device**, tick “**Delete the driver software for this device**”, confirm.
- Unplug the Push 2 USB cable, wait a few seconds, plug it back in (or Action → *Scan for hardware changes*). Windows reinstalls the default driver.
- Launch **Ableton Live** — it re-establishes its own Push 2 connection. If Live still does not see it, repair/reinstall Live so it reinstalls its Push 2 driver.

To switch back to the bridge later, simply re-run the Zadig WinUSB step above. You can flip between WinUSB (bridge) and the Ableton driver (Live) as often as you like — it is a 30-second operation each way.

Step 3 — Install the MIDI Remote script

- Copy **Ableton_Push2.js** into the Steinberg MIDI Remote scripts folder, creating the sub-folders if they do not exist:

Nuendo: C:\Users\<user>\Documents\Steinberg\Nuendo\MIDI Remote\Driver Scripts\Local\Ableton\Push2\
Cubase: C:\Users\<user>\Documents\Steinberg\Cubase\MIDI Remote\Driver Scripts\Local\Ableton\Push2\

Replace <user> with your Windows user name. The Local\Ableton\Push2 sub-folders usually do not exist yet — create them.

Step 4 — Run the bridge

- Connect the Push 2 by USB (and make sure Ableton Live is closed).
- **Double-click the .exe.** A console window opens and shows the startup status:

```
[0/3] Plugin Mapper: running at http://localhost:8100  
[1/3] Connecting to MIDI ports...  
[2/3] Connecting to Push 2...  
[3/3] Bridge is running!
```

- The console prints a framed **Plugin Mapper link** (<http://localhost:8100>) and opens it in your browser automatically. Most terminals also let you Ctrl+click the link. Launch the .exe with `--no-browser` to skip the auto-open.
- Keep the console window open while you work — it shows live status and any errors. Press **Ctrl+C** (or close the window) to stop the bridge.

Windows SmartScreen may warn on first launch because the .exe is not code-signed. Click “More info → Run anyway”. The CI-built release is reproducible from the public source.

Step 5 — Nuendo / Cubase configuration

Automatic setup: Nuendo usually detects the script and assigns its ports on its own when you open a project.

If the script does not load automatically

- Open any project.
- Studio → MIDI Remote Manager → **Add MIDI Controller Surface**.
- Vendor = **Ableton**, Model = **Push2**.
- MIDI Input = **NuendoBridge Out**, MIDI Output = **NuendoBridge In**.

Note Input

Set the instrument track's MIDI input to **BridgeNotes** (enable it in Studio Setup → MIDI Port Setup if hidden).

Important — avoid doubled notes

- In Studio Setup → MIDI Port Setup, **uncheck “In ‘All MIDI Inputs’” for both Push 2 ports** — “Ableton Push 2” (Live Port) and “Ableton Push 2 User Port”. Otherwise every pad is received twice.

Plugin Mapper (optional)

- The Plugin Mapper web server is bundled and starts automatically with the .exe — no extra install. Open <http://localhost:8100> (the console prints and opens the link) to create custom plugin parameter mappings. See the Plugin Mapper Guide for details.

Troubleshooting

- **“Could not connect to Push 2”** — Close Ableton Live; re-check the Zadig WinUSB driver (Step 2); reconnect the USB cable.
- **“Could not open MIDI ports”** — loopMIDI is not running or the four port names are not exactly as in Step 1.
- **Push 2 connects but Nuendo does nothing** — The MIDI Remote script is missing or the surface ports are wrong (Step 3 / Step 5).
- **Doubled pad notes** — Uncheck the two Push 2 ports from “In All MIDI Inputs” (Step 5).
- **SmartScreen / antivirus blocks the .exe** — Allow it; PyInstaller one-file executables are a common false positive.

Support

- Website: <https://push2bridge.kaikuaudio.com>
- Issues: <https://github.com/mbourque-mix/Push2Nuendo-Bridge/issues>

Licensed under GPL-3.0. Built with push2-python and the Steinberg MIDI Remote API.